수험영어를 넘어 세상을 보는 창

2026 WINTER

SIMSON DEBATE

Jan. B


RENT



THBT rent freezes are a form of harmful populism.

- ☐ **stability** n. 안정, 안정성
- ☐ **distort** v. 왜곡하다
- ☐ **imbalance** n. 불균형
- ☐ **landlord** n. 집주인, 임대인
- ☐ **decrease** v. 감소하다
- ☐ **financial** adj. 재정의, 금전적인
- ☐ **inequality** n. 불평등
- ☐ **vulnerable** adj. 취약한, 보호가 필요한
- ☐ **unfairness** n. 불공정함, 불공평함
- ☐ **necessary** adj. 필요한, 필수적인

DAY 1

Learning about the Topic

Brainstorming

Motion **THBT rent freezes are a form of harmful populism.**

key terms

rent freeze: a policy that stops rent from going up for a certain time

populism: a policy or idea that sounds good to many people but causes problems later

Think about the Motion!

1. Do you think rent freezes can help people in the short term?

Answers may vary

2. Do you think rent freezes can cause problems in the long run?

Answers may vary

Vocabulary

Write the correct word for each definition and make a sentence using the word.

stability	distort	imbalance	landlord	decrease
financial	inequality	vulnerable	unfairness	necessary

1. (landlord) : a person who owns a house or apartment and rents it to others

e.g

2. (inequality) : a situation where people do not have the same rights or chances

e.g

3. (stability) : a state of being steady and not changing

e.g

4. (decrease) : to become smaller or less

e.g

5. (vulnerable) : easily hurt or needing protection

e.g

6. (financial) : related to money

e.g

7. (unfairness) : the state of not being fair

e.g

8. (distort) : to change something so it is not true or correct

e.g

9. (necessary) : needed; must be done

e.g

10. (imbalance) : a situation where things are not equal or fair

e.g

Motion **THBT rent freezes are a form of harmful populism.**

Purpose To discuss how rent freezes affect the economy and society and what problems they may cause.

Background

Is a rent freeze populism or a helpful policy?

People can live in a house they buy or in a house they rent. When people rent a house, they pay money every month. This money is called rent. A rent freeze stops rent from going up for a certain time. Many people say rent freezes help renters. They say it is a quick way to stop rent from rising too fast.

But people do not all agree. Some people think rent freezes are harmful populism. Others think they are very important for housing **stability**.

Because of this, rent freezes are debated from many sides. People talk about them in economic ways and social ways.

Perspective 1 : Economic

Pro (Populism that distorts the market)

Some people think rent freezes are a form of populism because they **distort** how the market works. While rent freezes may become popular in the short term, they argue that in the long run they cause economic problems and market **imbalance**. For example, in 2019, Berlin in Germany introduced a rent freeze policy. This policy helped some renters for a short time, but over time it caused housing shortages and made rents rise very quickly.

When rent cannot move freely, **landlords** earn less money, so some stop renting out their homes while others stop repairing and managing them properly. As a result, the supply of rental housing **decreases**, and rent may increase sharply in the long run.

In addition, governments often try to support the rental market by building public housing or giving subsidies, but this can lead to higher taxes and **financial** problems. For these reasons, rent freezes are often criticized as a populist policy.

Con (Economic Stability Measure)

On the other hand, some people see rent freezes as a way to keep the economy stable. They argue that rent freezes can reduce the harm caused by fast-rising rents to people and to the economy. When rent is frozen, people have more money left to spend on other things, which can help the local economy. For example, in Barcelona, Spain, rent freezes helped stop housing costs from rising too fast and made life easier for people. This helped the local economy.

When housing costs stay stable, people can spend more money on other things. This helps shops and businesses. In this way, rent freezes stop rent from rising suddenly and help keep the market stable for a short time.

Perspective 2 : Social

Pro (Causing Social Inequality)

From a social view, some people say rent freezes are not fair. They say rent freezes help people who already live in rented homes, but people who want to move to a new home face higher rent and fewer choices. This can make life unfair for some people. For example, in Barcelona, Spain, rent freezes helped current renters for a short time, but new renters later had fewer homes to choose from and had to pay more rent.

Because of this, young people and newly married couples can have a harder time finding a home. Over time, this can make social **inequality** worse. For these reasons, some people say rent freezes are a populist and unfair policy.

Con (Protecting the Vulnerable)

On the other hand, some people say rent freezes help protect **vulnerable** people in society. They say that without government rules, rent can rise faster than people's income, which makes life harder for poor people and young people. For example, in Vienna, Austria, strong rent rules and many public houses have helped people find homes at lower prices. This has helped reduce **unfairness** in society.

In this way, rent freezes can give short-term safety and help vulnerable people live more securely. They also help people with different incomes live together, which can make society more united.

Conclusion

Is it populism or a practical solution? The debate over rent freezes remains a hot social issue, with criticism that it is populism and arguments that it is an essential solution from both economic and social perspectives. Some worry that it distorts market functions and increases social inequality, seeing it as short-term populism, while others argue that rent freezes are a **necessary** measure to protect the public and ensure economic stability.

In the end, for this policy to be an effective solution, the design and implementation of the policy are crucial, and an approach that balances short-term stability with long-term sustainability is needed.

Reading Comprehension

1. How does the Pro side say rent freezes hurt the economy, and what example is used?

The Pro side says rent freezes hurt the economy because they reduce the number of rental homes. When rent is frozen, landlords may stop renting their homes or stop fixing them. This can cause a lack of homes and make rent go up later. For example, in Berlin, Germany, rent freezes helped renters at first, but later caused housing shortages and higher rents.

2. How does the Con side say rent freezes help the economy, and what example is given?

The Con side says rent freezes help the economy by keeping housing costs stable. When people pay less rent, they have more money to spend on other things, which helps local businesses. For example, in Barcelona, Spain, rent freezes helped control housing costs and reduced people's money burden, helping the local economy.

3. From a social view, how does the Pro side say rent freezes cause unfairness, and what example is used?

The Pro side says rent freezes are unfair because they help only people who already rent homes. New renters may face higher rent and fewer choices. For example, in Barcelona, existing renters benefited, but new renters had fewer homes to choose from and had to pay more rent.

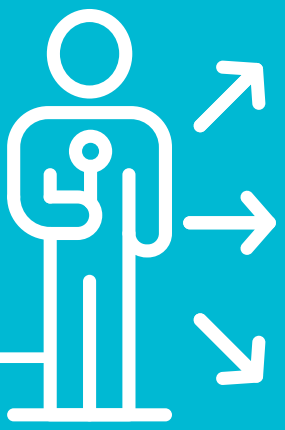
4. How does the Con side say rent freezes protect weak people, and what example is given?

The Con side says rent freezes protect vulnerable people like the poor and young. Without rules, rent can rise too fast and make life harder. For example, in Vienna, Austria, public housing and rent rules helped keep housing affordable and reduced unfairness.

5. What is the final conclusion about rent freezes, and what is needed for the policy to work well?

The conclusion says rent freezes can help in the short term but may cause problems later. To work well, the policy must be planned carefully and balance short–term help with long–term solutions.

DAY 2



Clash Points

Figure out the Clash Points VS ↔

In terms of Economy

1 Proposition argues that:

Populism that Distorts the Market

Rent freezes may be popular for a short time, but they can hurt how the market works in the long run and cause economic problems.

When rent is controlled, landlords earn less money, so some stop renting their homes or stop fixing and taking care of them.

Because of this, there are fewer rental homes, and rent may go up a lot later. (Example: Berlin, Germany, 2019)

Rebuttals Economic Stability Measure

Rent freezes can help people when rent rises too fast and can also help the economy.

When rent stays stable, people have more money to spend on other things, which helps local shops and creates a good cycle in the economy.

In terms of Economy

1 Opposition argues that:

Economic Stability Measure

Rent freezes are seen as a way to keep the economy stable and help people when housing costs rise too fast.

When rent is frozen, people feel less money pressure even if their income does not rise as fast as housing costs.

Rent freezes stop rent from rising suddenly and help keep the market stable for a short time. (Example: Barcelona, Spain)

Rebuttals Populism that Distorts the Market

When rent cannot move freely, landlords earn less money, so some stop renting their homes or stop fixing them.

Because of this, there are fewer homes to rent, and rent may go up a lot in the future.

Also, when the government builds public housing or gives money to help, taxes may go up and government money problems can happen.

Figure out the Clash Points VS ↔

In terms of society

2 Proposition argues that:

Causing Social Inequality

This policy mainly helps people who already rent homes, but new renters may face higher rent and fewer choices.

While existing tenants get short-term help, young people and newlyweds who are looking for a new home may have to pay more and have fewer places to choose from.

Because this situation can increase inequality between generations, the policy is criticized as unfair since it protects existing tenants more than other vulnerable groups, such as new renters.

Rebuttals Protecting the Vulnerable

Without government rules, rent can rise faster than people's income and make society more unfair.

Rent freezes give short-term safety to young people and low-income groups who struggle to find stable housing because rent is too high.

In terms of society

2 Opposition argues that:

Protecting the Vulnerable

Rent freezes are an important policy to help vulnerable people afford housing.

They give short-term stability, so vulnerable people can live more safely.

By keeping housing affordable, rent freezes help people with different incomes live together in society.

(Example: Vienna, Austria, with public housing and strong rent rules)

Rebuttals Causing Social Inequality

The policy helps only people who already rent homes, while new renters like young people and newlyweds have fewer housing choices.

This makes it harder for new renters to improve their lives and can increase unfairness between current renters and new renters.

DAY 3

☞ **Step 1: Finish Your Template**

❶ Prepare your arguments for both sides at home.

❷ Listen to your friend's ideas and add the teacher's tips to complete your template.

☞ **Step 2: Practice with a Partner**

❶ Pair up with a classmate.

❷ Take turns being Proposition and Opposition and role-play the debate, using your templates.



Mock Debate Drill

Prime Minister

Hello everyone, I am the Prime Minister. First, let me introduce to you the motion of the debate.

Today's debate is about the rent freeze policy. This is a topic many people disagree about. We believe that rent freezes are harmful populism from an economic point of view.

First, rent freezes hurt how the market works. Rent needs to go up and down so there are enough homes to rent. When rent is fixed, landlords earn less money, so they may stop renting out homes or stop fixing them. Because of this, there are fewer homes to rent, and rent may go up even more later.

Second, rent freezes cause money problems for the government. When the rental market becomes weaker, the government may need to build more public housing or give money to help people. This can lead to higher taxes and money problems in the future. Even if it looks helpful now, it can hurt the economy later.

From a social point of view, similar problems happen.

First, rent freezes can hurt vulnerable people in the long run. At first, rent may seem stable, but later there are fewer homes and lower-quality housing. Young people, newly married couples, and low-income people who want to find homes will face more competition, fewer choices, and higher costs.

Second, rent freezes increase unfairness between generations. Rent freezes help only people who already live in rental homes. New renters face higher prices and fewer choices. This makes it harder for people to improve their lives and makes inequality worse.

For these reasons, rent freezes do not help social stability. Instead, they can make vulnerable people even more vulnerable.

Leader of Opposition

Hello everyone, I am the Leader of Opposition, and I am here to dissent the motion.

The government says rent freezes are harmful populism, but we believe this policy is needed for both the economy and society. First, from an economic view, rent freezes can have good effects. When rent is frozen, people have more money left to spend on other things. This helps local shops and makes the economy stronger. Keeping housing costs stable helps create a good cycle in the economy. So, controlling rent increases is important for economic stability.

From a social view, rent freezes are also important. They help protect people, especially young people and low-income groups. If rent rises too fast, some people may lose their homes, which can harm their school life, jobs, and families. Rent freezes help keep housing stable and protect vulnerable people.

Rent freezes can also reduce inequality. Today, rent is rising faster than income, making life unfair. Rent freezes help close this gap and make sure everyone can have a basic place to live. This is an important role of the government.

For these reasons, we believe rent freezes are not populism. They are an important policy to help stabilize the housing market.

Deputy Prime Minister

Hello everyone, I am the Deputy Prime Minister.

I will respond to the LO's points from an economic view.

First, LO says rent freezes give people more money to spend and help the local economy. However, when rent is frozen, many landlords stop renting out their homes or sell them. This makes homes harder to find. When housing becomes scarce, rent goes up even more, and low-income people suffer the most. Instead of helping people spend more, rent freezes can raise housing costs and reduce spending overall. Second, LO says rent freezes stop sudden rent increases. But while rent is frozen, landlords leave the market. When the freeze ends, rent can rise very fast all at once. This sudden rise makes the market more unstable, not safer. So the stability LO talks about is only temporary and not real.

Now, I will respond to LO's social arguments. First, LO says rent freezes protect vulnerable people, but in reality, young people and newly married couples are hurt the most. When there are fewer homes to rent, they must compete more and pay higher prices. This does not truly protect vulnerable people. Second, LO says rent freezes reduce inequality. But rent freezes help only people who already rent homes. New renters are left out, which increases unfairness between generations.

In conclusion, LO's ideas may sound kind, but they do not work well in real life. Rent freezes are harmful populism that focus on short-term popularity, not long-term solutions.

Deputy Leader of Opposition

Hello everyone, I am the Deputy Leader of Opposition.

I will now respond to the PM's points from an economic view.

First, PM said that rent freezes reduce the number of homes and make rent rise more later. However, this problem can be controlled with good policy design. Rent freezes can be used only for a short time or only in areas where rent is rising too fast. At the same time, the government can build more public housing. Rent freezes are not meant to stop the market forever. They are a temporary way to calm sudden changes. Second, PM talked about the money burden on the government. But fast rent increases also cause big social costs. When people must move often or live far from work, work becomes less efficient and welfare costs rise. Rent freezes can lower these problems and actually help the economy.

Now, I will respond to PM's social arguments.

First, PM said rent freezes hurt vulnerable people more. But the real harm happens when rent rises too fast. Rent freezes are the minimum action needed to stop this problem. When rent rises much faster than income, the government must step in to protect housing rights. Second, PM said rent freezes help only current tenants. But rent freezes slow down rent increases in the whole market. This helps new renters by stopping sudden and extreme rent hikes.

Also, rent freezes give the government time to improve public housing and housing policies. This helps not only people today, but also future generations.

In short, the real problem is rent rising without control. Rent freezes are the first safety step to stop this harmful cycle.

Government Whip

Hello everyone, I am the Government Whip

Today, the government side has shown that rent freezes are harmful populism from both economic and social views.

First, from an economic view, rent freezes hurt how the market works and reduce the number of rental homes. When landlords cannot earn enough money, they stop renting homes or stop fixing them. This leads to fewer homes and poorer housing quality. Over time, rent can rise even more. Also, the government then needs to spend more money on public housing or help programs, which can lead to higher taxes and money problems.

Next, from a social view, rent freezes may look like they protect vulnerable people, but they actually make life harder for young people and newly married couples who need new homes. With fewer homes available, they face fewer choices and higher costs, which makes unfairness between generations worse.

The opposition says rent freezes help people spend more and reduce unfairness, but this looks only at short-term effects and ignores long-term problems like fewer homes and a broken market.

For these reasons, the government side believes that rent freezes are harmful populist policies that cannot last economically or socially.

Opposition Whip

Hello everyone, I am the Opoosition Whip

First, from an economic view, when rent rises too fast, low-income people lose buying power, and the local economy becomes weaker. Rent freezes help slow down these sharp increases and reduce money pressure on families. This policy does not harm the economy. Instead, it helps control sudden market changes in the short term.

Next, from a social view, rent freezes are the minimum safety net to protect young people and low-income groups from losing their homes. When rent rises much faster than income, life becomes more unfair without government action. Rent freezes are the first step to stopping this harmful cycle.

The government side worries about fewer homes and more inequality, but these problems can be reduced by using rent freezes only for a short time, only in some areas, and by building more public housing. The real problem is not protection itself, but rent rising out of control without any protection.

For these reasons, the opposition side believes that rent freezes are not harmful populism, but a necessary policy in today's unfair housing situation.

Practice with Your Partner

☞ **Role play with your partner for 10 minutes based on the template.**

My Partner:

Round 1

My role: Proposition / Opposition

Stance:

Notes

Round 2

My role: Proposition / Opposition

Stance:

Notes

DAY 4

☞ **Actual Debate**

try it without looking at the templates for Proposition and Opposition!

The more you practice at home, the more confident you will be!



Actual Debate

Debate Judge ballot

Tournament: Simson Debate Competition 2024		Date:
Round:	Room:	Print Judge Name:
Motion:		

PROP TEAM *name:*		**OPP TEAM** *name:*	

List the last names of the speakers of each team below, along with their score *(see rubric on the back)*.
REMINDER: Scores should be between 67-83 for the three speeches. *(see scoring standards on back)*.

Proposition Speakers		Opposition Speakers	
1	Name:	1	Name:
Speaker 1 Total Points *(67–83)*:	/83–67	Speaker 1 Total Points *(67–83)*:	/83–67
2	Name:	2	Name
Speaker 2 Total Points *(67–83)*:	/83–67	Speaker 2 Total Points *(67–83)*:	/83–67
3	Name:	3	Name:
Speaker 3 Total Points *(67–83)*:	/83–67	Speaker 3 Total Points *(67–83)*:	/83–67

THE TEAM WITH THE MOST POINTS, WINNING THE DEBATE IS: *(There are no 'low point wins'—the team with the higher score wins)*

TEAM NAME: REPRESENTING THE *(circle one)*: PROPOSITION OPPOSITION

PROP TOTAL POINTS:		**OPP TOTAL POINTS:**	

COMMENTS:

Judge Signature:	Campus:

Debate Instructions to Judges

DIRECTIONS:

In the Simson debate, the winning team is the one with the most points—there are no low-point wins. Use the guidelines below to determine your scores.

STANDARDS FOR SCORING:
Every speech is scored out of a possible 83 points.

Note: For purposes of consistency, scores should be between 67 and 83 for the three speeches per team. Judges should not go outside this range.

You may give or take away 1 or 2 points, per debater, for strong/weak offering and receiving of Points of Information.

81-83	• Brilliant arguments successfully engage with the main issues in the round. • Arguments are very well-explained, always central to the case being advocated, and demand extremely sophisticated responses. • The speech is very clear and incredibly compelling. Structure and role fulfillment are executed flawlessly.
79-80	• Very good, central arguments engage well with the most important issues on the table and are highly compelling; sophisticated responses would be required to refute them. • Delivery is clear and very persuasive. Role fulfillment and structure are probably flawless.
77-78	• Relevant and pertinent arguments address key issues in the round with sufficient explanation. • The speech is clear in almost its entirety, and holds one's attention persuasively. • Role is well-fulfilled and structure is unlikely to be problematic.
74-76	• Arguments are almost exclusively relevant, and frequently persuasive. Occasionally, but not often, the speaker may slip into: i) deficits in explanation, ii) simplistic argumentation vulnerable to competent responses, or iii) peripheral or irrelevant arguments. • The speaker holds one's attention, provides clear structure, and successfully fulfills their basic role on the table.
72-73	• Arguments are generally relevant, and some explanation of them given, but there may be obvious gaps in logic, multiple points of peripheral or irrelevant material and simplistic argumentation. • The speaker mostly holds the audience's attention and is usually clear, but rarely compelling, and may sometimes be difficult to follow. • There is a decent but incomplete attempt to fulfill one's role on the table, and structure may be imperfectly delivered.
70-71	• Relevant arguments are frequently made, but with very rudimentary explanation. • The speaker is clear enough to be understood the vast majority of the time, but this may be difficult and/or unrewarding. • Structure poor; poor attempt to fulfill role.
69	• The speaker is often relevant, but rarely makes full arguments. • Frequently unclear and confusing; really problematic structure/lack thereof; some awareness of role.
68	• The speech rarely makes relevant claims, only occasionally formulated as arguments. • Hard to follow, little/no structure; no evident awareness of role.
67	• No structure or fulfillment of role in any meaningful sense is provided, OR did not speak at all.

What is a POI?

A POI means **Point Of Information**
It is something you raise during the speech of your opponent when something in their speech doesn't add up or when you want a clarification to something they have said.

A POI is a very important part of a debate since you get to either rebut or question your opponents arguments or definitions in real time!

You may raise a POI by respectfully saying "point" and raising your right hand during your appointments speech.

You may raise a point after your opponents first definition or argument.
If your opponent has not introduced any definitions or arguments you may not raise a point, since there is nothing to clarify in that case.

But, note that all speakers have the freedom to accept or reject any offered POI's.

So if your POI has been denied please respect the speaker for doing so.

Let's Make a POI!

1.

2.

3.

4.

5.

Actual Debate

Academic Essay

Essay Writing Guide

☞ **We will write an essay using what we learned in Day 1(motion), Day 2(clash points), and Day 3(debate templates).**

☞ **Write your essay online in 4 paragraphs:**

Intro - Body 1 - Body 2 - Conclusion

Instruction	Write like this!
[Intro] In the Intro, **we use the motion**. Do you agree or disagree with the motion we learned?	I (agree / disagree) with the motion, “ _____ .” *(motion)*
[Body] **In the Body, we write the reasons for our side (agree or disagree).** **Use examples or explanations from the** **① text (Day1),** **② clash points (Day2),** **③ Templates (Day3).** **④ or your own ideas.**	**Body 1** The most important reason is that _____ . I think this is important because _____ . For example, _____ . **Body 2** The next important reason is that _____ . I also believe this matters because _____ . For example, _____ .
[Conclusion] The Conclusion is the ending. ① Summarize your Body ② Restate your opinion about the motion	① In conclusion, I (agree / disagree) with the motion because _____ and _____ . ② Therefore, _____ .

↳ Example

Intro

I agree with the motion, "THBT rent freezes are a form of harmful populism."

Body 1

The most important reason is that rent freezes harm the economy in the long run.

I think this is important because rent must change freely to keep enough homes on the market.

For example, in Berlin, Germany, rent freezes helped some renters at first, but later caused housing shortages and sharply rising rents.

Body 2

The next important reason is that rent freezes increase social inequality instead of reducing it.

I believe this matters because rent freezes help only people who already live in rental homes.

For example, in cities with rent freezes, new renters often struggle more than before because there are fewer homes available.

Conclusion

In conclusion, I agree with the motion because rent freezes may look helpful at first but cause serious economic and social problems over time.

Therefore, rent freezes are harmful populism that focus on short-term popularity rather than real solutions.